VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

As the Student Digital Ambassador for my batch at VIT Bhopal, this project serves as a comprehensive initiative to bridge the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital competence. In today's hyper-connected academic and professional landscape, simply being "online" is insufficient; one must be digitally literate. This project encompasses five key modules: creating visual awareness resources, establishing a professional digital identity, mastering collaborative cloud tools, practicing elite email etiquette, and understanding the grave realities of cybercrime. By documenting these tasks, this report aims to provide a roadmap for students to navigate the digital world safely, effectively, and professionally, ensuring that our collective "digital tattoo" reflects our best academic and technical capabilities.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness

Tool & Design Description

For this task, I used Canva due to its extensive library of educational icons and layout grids. My infographic, titled "Navigating the Digital Frontier," is designed as a vertical flow intended for social media or a student newsletter. It focuses on three pillars: defining digital literacy, identifying high-impact productivity tools, and maintaining a professional online presence. I utilized a high-contrast colour palette of navy and cyan to ensure readability while maintaining a professional "tech" aesthetic. Each section uses "snackable" text—short, punchy sentences—to ensure my batchmates can grasp the concepts at a glance.

Reflection

One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was the concept of the "Digital Tattoo." While researching professional online presence, I realized how permanent digital footprints are; it isn't just about "hiding" bad content, but actively "planting" good content to define your brand. The most difficult part was spatial management—distilling complex ideas like digital ethics into just a few bullet points without losing the core message. Balancing visual white space with informative content required several iterations to get right.

Task 2 Write-up: Professional Portfolio Setup

Platform Selection & Purpose

For this task, I established and updated professional presences on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose these platforms because they represent the "holy trinity" for an AIML student. GitHub serves as my version-controlled code repository where I can showcase my Java and Python projects. LinkedIn acts as my digital resume and networking hub to connect with industry professionals and VIT alumni. Finally, I chose Kaggle as it is the premier platform for data science competitions and datasets, which aligns directly with my specialization in Artificial Intelligence.

Future Planning

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a longitudinal record of my growth. On GitHub, I will document my daily "100 Days of Code" as I transition from Java basics to advanced DSA. On LinkedIn, I intend to share updates on hackathons—like my experience with Health Hack 2026—and secure internship opportunities for my third year. On Kaggle, I aim to move from being a "Novice" to a "Contributor" by participating in at least two machine learning competitions per year. By graduation in 2028, these platforms will provide tangible proof of my technical competency and professional consistency.

Task 3 Write-up: Digital Tools and Collaboration

Platform & Practice

For this module, I utilized HackerRank for technical skill validation and Google Workspace (Forms and Sheets) for collaborative data collection. On HackerRank, I completed the Java introductory challenges, successfully implementing basic I/O operations and logic gates to earn my first points toward a Bronze badge. For the collaboration component, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This involved structuring five diverse question types to assess my batchmates' understanding of online safety and professional branding, with the backend responses automatically synced to a Google Sheet for real-time analysis.

Academic Impact

These tools are vital for my academic journey at VIT. HackerRank provides a standardized environment similar to the Technical Assessment (TA) rounds I will face during campus placements in 2028. Mastering it now allows me to focus on complex Data Structures later. Similarly, Google Workspace proficiency is essential for our lab projects and hackathons. The ability to quickly deploy a survey and analyze results via Sheets will help me gather user feedback for future iterations of my Medi-Mind project, ensuring that my technical solutions are grounded in actual student needs.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Communication

The Role of Digital Etiquette

In the professional world, especially within the field of Computer Science, your communication style is often the first technical "test" you pass. For this task, I developed two distinct communication assets: a formal extension request to a professor and a cold-outreach internship inquiry. Both required a balance of brevity, clarity, and professional tone.

I structured these emails using a four-point professional framework:

1. **Direct Subject Lines: Including my Name, Registration Number, and the specific purpose (e.g., "Extension Request" or "Internship Inquiry") to ensure the recipient can categorize the email at a glance.**
2. **Formal Salutations: Using "Dear Professor [Name]" rather than informal greetings like "Hey" or "Respected Sir."**
3. **Action-Oriented Body: Clearly stating the "ask" (the extension or the interview) and providing the necessary context (health issues or the Medi-Mind project).**
4. **Professional Sign-off: Including a digital signature that lists my branch (CSE AIML) and relevant links like my GitHub and LinkedIn.**

Social Media Ethics for Students

Beyond email, I developed a "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist to guide my batchmates through the transition from personal to professional social media use. The most critical takeaway from this list is the concept of Separation of Concerns: keeping personal "venting" entirely private while using public-facing platforms like LinkedIn to broadcast technical wins, such as our participation in the Health Hack 2026.

Reflection on Communication Failures

Researching this topic led me to analyze the "Accidental Reply-All" phenomenon. In a high-stakes academic environment like VIT Bhopal, a single unprofessional message sent to the wrong thread can result in long-term reputational damage. This task taught me the importance of the "Public Test": the habit of never typing anything in a digital medium that I would not be comfortable seeing on a physical billboard.

This module has reinforced that as an AIML student, my code might be my product, but my communication is my brand. Mastering these nuances now ensures that when I reach out to recruiters in my third and fourth years, my digital presence will be a catalyst for my career, not a barrier.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

Case Study Analysis

For this module, I conducted a deep-dive into UPI (Unified Payments Interface) Fraud, specifically focusing on the "Collect Request" scam. This crime involves social engineering where a bad actor poses as a buyer or an official and sends a payment link or QR code to the victim. The core deception lies in the victim believing they are "receiving" money, when in fact, they are authorizing a "debit" from their own account the moment they enter their UPI PIN.

The typical workflow of this crime follows a sophisticated pattern:

1. **Selection: Scammers target students selling items on marketplaces or those seeking "technical support" for banking apps.**
2. **Urgency: The scammer creates a high-pressure environment, claiming a deal will expire or an account will be locked.**
3. **The Trap: A QR code is sent via WhatsApp with the instruction to "Scan and enter PIN to verify the credit."**
4. **Execution: Once the PIN is entered, the victim's bank account is instantly debited, and the funds are moved through a series of "mule" accounts to make recovery difficult.**

Prevention and Strategic Habits

To combat this, I developed an eight-point "Stay Safe Online" checklist. Two critical takeaways for Indian students are:

- **The Golden Rule of UPI: A PIN is only required to *send* money, never to *receive* it.**
- **The Reporting Protocol: Immediate reporting via the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or the 1930 Helpline is the only way to potentially freeze fraudulent transactions before they leave the banking system.**

Personal Reflection and Habit Change

What surprised me most during this research was the sheer scale of social engineering. It isn't just a technical "hack"; it is a psychological manipulation that exploits a student's desire for efficiency or fear of losing out. I was startled to find that even high-performing engineering students are susceptible when a scammer uses the correct "script."

One habit I am personally changing as a result of this task is my approach to Mobile App Permissions. I discovered that several third-party utility apps on my phone had

unnecessary access to my SMS and Contacts, which is a significant vulnerability for OTP interception. I have since audited my device, revoked these permissions, and moved my primary professional accounts (GitHub and LinkedIn) to App-based Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) rather than relying on SMS, which is much more secure against SIM-swapping and phishing.

Conclusion

This project has significantly broadened my perspective on what it means to be a student in the AI & ML era. Beyond coding and technical labs, the ability to communicate professionally, secure one's digital identity, and use collaborative tools effectively is what defines a successful modern engineer. I have learned that my digital footprint is permanent—a "tattoo" rather than a "trace." Moving forward, I am committed to maintaining these professional standards and serving as a guide for my peers, ensuring we all navigate the digital landscape with integrity and skill.

References

- **Canva (Design Tool) - https://www.canva.com**
- **GitHub (Version Control & Portfolio) - https://github.com**
- **HackerRank (Coding Practice) - https://www.hackerrank.com**
- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal - https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- **VIT Bhopal Academic Guidelines (Internal Reference)**